**Listing 2.4 The chat completions request**

```
response = client.chat.completions.create(
    model="gpt-4-1106-preview",                 #1
    messages=[{"role": "system",
"content": "You are a helpful assistant."},                      #2
             {"role": "user", "content": user_message}],      #3
    temperature=0.7,     #4
    )
```

**#1 The model or deployment used to respond to the request**
**#2 The system role message**
**#3 The user role message**
**#4 The temperature or variability of the request**

Within the request, the `messages` block describes a set of messages and roles used in a request. Messages for a chat completions model can be defined in three roles:

- *System role*—A message that describes the request's rules and guidelines. It can often be used to describe the role of the LLM in making the request.
- *User role*—Represents and contains the message from the user.
- *Assistant role*—Can be used to capture the message history of previous responses from the LLM. It can also inject a message history when perhaps none existed.

The message sent in a single request can encapsulate an entire conversation, as shown in the JSON in the following listing.

**Listing 2.5 Messages with history**

```
[
    {
        "role": "system",
        "content": "You are a helpful assistant."
    },
    {
        "role": "user",
        "content": "What is the capital of France?"
    },
    {
        "role": "assistant",
        "content": "The capital of France is Paris."
    },
    {
        "role": "user",
        "content": "What is an interesting fact of Paris."
    }
],
```